Lesson 1.2: Dealing With Our Sin

Genesis 3 · Series 1: In the Beginning · About 20 minutes · Big idea: **Sorry is not enough. Repentance is turning around.**

Written by Andrew Young

> **Key verse: Luke 9:23**
>
> 23 And he said to them all, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily, and follow me.

Bring: candy · the 4 part sheets printed

1. Testimony 2 min

One student, or one of us teachers, gives a testimony. If they get stuck, I'll ask: *tell us about a time you said sorry, and then actually changed.*

2. Act it out: Bro, I Said Sorry! 4 min

Four boys: Jake, Tyler, Marcus, Ben. Hand out the parts and read straight through. No props, no moving around, no practice needed.

Bro, I Said Sorry!

Jake · Tyler · Marcus · Ben

JAKE **Bro, why did you tell everybody I screamed when that little dog chased me?**

TYLER **Because you did scream.**

JAKE **It was not a scream!**

MARCUS **I heard it from inside the house.**

BEN **I thought somebody was getting kidnapped.**

JAKE **It was a very aggressive dog!**

TYLER **It was a Chihuahua.**

JAKE **THAT DOESN'T MATTER!**

TYLER **Okay, okay. I'm sorry. I shouldn't have told everybody.**

JAKE **Thank you. Just stop telling people.**

TYLER I got you, bro.

BEN So what are y'all doing after church?

TYLER I don't know. Probably going to Jake's house. Hopefully his mom doesn't make him eat vegetables again.

JAKE Tyler!

MARCUS Wait, what?

TYLER Oh, last week his mom made broccoli, and Jake sat there gagging like he was dying.

BEN Over broccoli?!

JAKE I TOLD YOU THAT IN PRIVATE!

TYLER My bad, bro. I'm sorry.

JAKE You just apologized for doing the exact same thing!

TYLER And I meant it!

JAKE Then STOP DOING IT!

TYLER Okay! I won't do it again. Promise.

MARCUS So, Jake, you coming to play basketball Saturday?

JAKE Yeah, probably.

TYLER As long as he doesn't shoot any three-pointers.

JAKE Tyler. Don't.

BEN Why not?

TYLER Because last time he shot one, it went over the backboard and hit somebody's grandma.

MARCUS NO WAY!

JAKE IT DID NOT HIT HER! IT LANDED NEXT TO HER!

TYLER See? He's still sensitive about it.

JAKE BRO! YOU HAVE GOT TO BE KIDDING ME!

TYLER What?! I'm sorry!

JAKE BRO! YOU KEEP SAYING YOU'RE SORRY!

TYLER Well, I AM sorry!

JAKE THEN WHY DO YOU KEEP DOING IT?!

BEN **I'm starting to think he doesn't know what sorry means.**

MARCUS **He knows how to say it. That's about it.**

TYLER **Man, y'all are making a big deal out of nothing.**

JAKE **And THAT is why I don't believe you're sorry!**

🍬 **1. How many times did Tyler say he was sorry? Then why did he keep doing it?**

Four times. He kept doing the same thing, and then defended it.

Now, let me ask y'all something. Do you think Tyler was actually sorry?

Maybe he was the first time. But he sure wasn't trying very hard to change, was he?

And here's the thing. We laugh at Tyler, but how many times do we do the same thing?

We do something we know is wrong, ask God to forgive us, and then turn around and do it again.

Now that doesn't mean if you mess up again, you weren't really sorry. We're all going to make mistakes. But there's a difference between struggling with something you're trying to overcome and continuing to do something you have no intention of giving up.

And that's what repentance is about. It's not just saying you're sorry. It's turning away from what you know is wrong.

Saying it is confessing. Turning away is forsaking. God wants both.

> **Proverbs 28:13**
>
> 13 He that covereth his sins shall not prosper: but whoso confesseth and forsaketh them shall have mercy.

3. What happened in the garden 6 min

God made everything good, and He made man to walk with Him. He gave Adam one rule.

> **Genesis 2:17**
>
> 17 But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.

The serpent got her to doubt God first: *"Yea, hath God said...?"* Then he called God a liar: *"Ye shall not surely die."*

> **Genesis 3:4-6**
>
> 4 And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die:
> 5 For God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof, then your eyes shall be opened, and ye shall be as gods, knowing good and evil.
> 6 And when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree to be desired to make one wise, she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave also unto her husband with her; and he did eat.

Now watch what they do when God comes walking.

> **Genesis 3:8-13**
>
> 8 And they heard the voice of the LORD God walking in the garden in the cool of the day: and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the LORD God amongst the trees of the garden.
> 9 And the LORD God called unto Adam, and said unto him, Where art thou?
> 10 And he said, I heard thy voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; and I hid myself.
> 11 And he said, Who told thee that thou wast naked? Hast thou eaten of the tree, whereof I commanded thee that thou shouldest not eat?
> 12 And the man said, The woman whom thou gavest to be with me, she gave me of the tree, and I did eat.
> 13 And the LORD God said unto the woman, What is this that thou hast done? And the woman said, The serpent beguiled me, and I did eat.

🍬 **2. Count them. How many times did Adam or Eve say "I'm sorry"? And who did Adam blame?**

ZERO. Adam blamed the woman, AND God: "the woman whom THOU gavest." Eve blamed the serpent. Follow up, no candy: *who do YOU blame?*

God told Adam not to eat the fruit. But when Eve repeated the command, she said they weren't even supposed to *touch* it! God gave that command to Adam before Eve was created, so it makes sense Adam taught her. Maybe he added that extra rule about touching it. The Bible doesn't tell us who added it.

But Adam knew what God said. Eve ate, and Adam was right there with her. He could have stood for God's command. Instead, he ate too! How can you tell somebody else to obey God when you won't obey Him yourself?

One day some of you will be husbands, fathers, and leaders. You can't lead somebody somewhere you're not willing to go yourself. God calls men to stand for what's right, not just know His Word, but live it. A godly leader doesn't have to be perfect. He needs to admit when he's wrong, repent, and lead by example.

> **Ezekiel 22:30**
>
> 30 And I sought for a man among them, that should make up the hedge, and stand in the gap before me for the land, that I should not destroy it: but I found none.

In Ezekiel's day, the leaders of Jerusalem had all gone bad. God looked for one man who would stand for what's right and pray for the land, so He wouldn't have to destroy it. He found none. Adam had a chance to stand for what God said, too. But he didn't stand. He joined in, then blamed everybody but himself.

4. God made a way 4 min

Sin still had to be judged. But God did not leave them there. He promised a Saviour from the woman's seed:

> **Genesis 3:15**
>
> 15 And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.

And He covered them. Fig leaves were their idea, but God made coats of skins for them. That covering cost a life. They couldn't fix what they'd done themselves, so God had to provide what they couldn't. And that points us to Jesus. No animal sacrifice could ever take away sin. Only Jesus could do that.

Genesis 3:21

21 Unto Adam also and to his wife did the LORD God make coats of skins, and clothed them.

Hebrews 10:4

4 For it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins.

⭐ Fun fact: Jesus walked it back

When Adam sinned, three things came in: the tree, the thorns, and the sweat. Jesus met all three, backwards.

1. The sweat: Adam sweat because he did it his way. Jesus sweat to do it God's way, so we can rest instead of sweating for it.

For me, if they ask: Adam: *"In the sweat of thy face shalt thou eat bread, till thou return unto the ground"* (Genesis 3:19). Jesus in the garden: *"nevertheless not my will, but thine, be done... and his sweat was as it were great drops of blood falling down to the ground"* (Luke 22:42, 44). Adam lost in a garden doing his own will. Jesus won in a garden by giving His up. For us: *"Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest"* (Matthew 11:28). We still work, but we don't sweat to earn our way back to God.

2. The thorns: Adam traded his crown for thorns. Jesus wore the thorns to win the crown back.

For me, if they ask: Adam was made king over the earth: *"have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over every living thing"* (Genesis 1:28). After he sinned the ground turned on him: *"Thorns also and thistles shall it bring forth to thee"* (Genesis 3:18). They mocked Jesus as a king with that curse: *"they had platted a crown of thorns, they put it upon his head... Hail, King of the Jews!"* (Matthew 27:29). He was *"made a curse for us"* (Galatians 3:13). Hebrews 2 ties it to Adam's crown itself: *"But now we see not yet all things put under him. But we see Jesus... for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honour"* (Hebrews 2:8-9).

3. The tree: Adam took from a tree to make himself God. God gave Himself on a tree to bring us back. Adam was naked, then God clothed him. Jesus was clothed, then they stripped Him naked.

For me, if they ask: The serpent: *"ye shall be as gods"* (Genesis 3:5). Jesus: *"thought it not robbery to be equal with God: But made himself of no reputation... and became obedient unto death, even the death of the cross"* (Philippians 2:6, 8). Adam was *"naked... and were not ashamed"* (Genesis 2:25), sinned, hid in shame, and God *"made coats of skins, and clothed them"* (Genesis 3:21). Jesus went the other way. The soldiers *"took his garments, and made four parts... and also his coat"* and gambled for it (John 19:23-24). The Bible doesn't say the word naked, but they took all of it, and the Romans usually crucified people naked to shame them. The cloth in paintings is church art. He *"endured the cross, despising the shame"* (Hebrews 12:2), so we could be clothed: *"he hath clothed*

me with the garments of salvation, he hath covered me with the robe of righteousness" (Isaiah 61:10). Adam was shut out from the tree of life (Genesis 3:24). Through Jesus: *"that they may have right to the tree of life"* (Revelation 22:14).

If they ask why we still sweat and thorns still grow: He fixed it spiritually now. The ground and our bodies are still waiting: *"And there shall be no more curse"* (Revelation 22:3).

Repentance is not a one time thing. Back to our key verse, Jesus said *daily*:

> **Luke 9:23 · already read, I'll say it**
>
> 23 And he said to them all, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross daily, and follow me.

Every day we put our flesh (our selfish nature) back on the altar.

5. My story 2 min

My story, as a teenager: I didn't want to repent. I was having a good time with my sneaky stuff, but I knew what it was going to cost. I didn't want to, and at the same time I wanted to, because I knew I needed to.

6. What would you do? 3 min

🍬 **3. You lost your temper with your little brother Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday, and said sorry every time. It is Thursday morning. What do you do?**

EVERYONE who answers gets candy. Good answers: turning around, pray first, walk away, go to God before it happens again.

> **Acts 3:19**
>
> 19 Repent ye therefore, and be converted, that your sins may be blotted out, when the times of refreshing shall come from the presence of the Lord;

The big church: the altar isn't only for when you've done something bad. It's where you go to turn around, any time. So when you see grown ups at the altar, it doesn't mean they're bad. They're doing what we just learned: confessing AND forsaking. Not just saying sorry, but turning around.

Prayer 1 min

- Lord, help me first see where I'm wrong.
- Help me be honest with myself: have I really repented?
- Do I even want to? If I don't, help me with that too.